HR-205 Promotion and Progression

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Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Owner: People Operations
Applies to: All permanent employees

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1 Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out how employees progress to a higher level, the eligibility requirements that must be met before a promotion can be considered, and how nominations are reviewed.

Promotion recognises that an employee is already operating at the next level. It is not a reward for tenure, and it is not a mechanism for adjusting pay.

2 The Career Framework

The company operates seven grades. Grades 1 and 2 are entry level, grades 3 and 4 are professional, grades 5 and 6 are senior, and grade 7 is executive.

Each grade has a published description covering scope of work, autonomy, and the impact expected. The description is the standard against which a nomination is assessed.

Movement between grades is promotion. Movement within a grade is a change of role and is handled by the hiring process, not this policy.

3 Promotion

3.1 Promotion Cycles

Promotions are considered twice a year, in March and September. Nominations close four weeks before the cycle opens.

Out-of-cycle promotions are discretionary and require the approval of an HR business partner. They are reserved for cases where waiting for the next cycle would create a material risk, and are not used to accelerate an ordinary case.

3.2 Promotion Eligibility Requirements

To be eligible for promotion, an employee must meet all of the following: twelve months of continuous service in their current grade at the date the cycle opens; a performance rating of Strong or above at the most recent year-end review; no active improvement plan under HR-203 section 6; and documented evidence of operating at the next grade for at least two quarters.

Meeting the eligibility requirements does not create an entitlement to promotion. It makes an employee eligible to be nominated.

3.3 Nomination and Panel Review

The employee's manager submits the nomination, which sets out the evidence against each element of the target grade description.

A panel of at least three managers from outside the employee's immediate team reviews each nomination. The panel assesses the evidence against the grade description and nothing else.

The panel's decision is recorded with its reasons and communicated by the employee's manager within ten working days of the cycle closing.

3.4 Unsuccessful Nominations

Where a nomination is unsuccessful, the manager explains which elements of the grade description were not evidenced and agrees what would need to change.

An unsuccessful nomination does not prevent nomination in a later cycle. There is no limit on the number of times an employee may be nominated.

An employee who believes the process was not followed may raise it with an HR business partner within ten working days. The panel's assessment of evidence is not itself subject to appeal.

4 Acting Up

Where an employee covers a role at a higher grade for more than eight consecutive weeks, the arrangement is recorded in writing with a defined end date.

Acting up is not promotion and does not create an entitlement to it. Evidence gathered while acting up may be used in a later nomination.

Any allowance payable while acting up is determined by an HR business partner and is outside this policy.

5 Records

Nominations, panel decisions and their reasons are retained for three years from the date of the decision.

6 Related Policies

Performance management is covered by HR-203. Flexible working is covered by HR-204.

Questions about salary, salary bands or bonus are not covered by this policy and must be directed to an HR business partner.

7 Review

This policy is reviewed every two years, or earlier where business practice changes.